Day 53 - Kimberley Forest, Valley Crossover, Wodehouse Karst

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Beaver Valley section · hike 64 · Kimberley Forest & Wodehouse Karst

12.2 km / 7.6 mi	~4.0 h	5.6 km new	123 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park: Roadside parking on 7th Line at the beginning of the Wodehouse Karst Side Trail. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day53_hike064.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Kimberley Forest Side Trail (2.5 km); Valley Crossover Side Trail (1.7 km); Wodehouse Karst Side Trail (1.5 km)

Route map

Day 53 | 12.2 km (7.6 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside on 7th Line at the start of the Wodehouse Karst Side Trail.
- **Wodehouse Karst:** Described as having one of the finest groups of sinkholes in southern Ontario. Wodehouse Creek disappears into a sinkhole and later re-emerges as a small cascade down the valley slope. There are views toward Old Baldy. Stay on the trail: the area mixes private and public land.
- **Kimberley Forest:** About 1,000 acres, mostly Crown land, with the Bruce Trail running north–south through it and the Beaver River flowing across the base of the forest. Licensed hunting and trapping are permitted, so in fall wear bright colours and put a bright vest on Zappy.
- **Road walking:** The Kimberley Forest and Valley Crossover side trails each include road-shoulder stretches. Keep Zappy close.
- **Valley Crossover Side Trail:** We found no published description of this side trail beyond the route data.
- **Length:** At about 12.8 km this is one of the longer days; allow extra time.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking on 7th Line at the beginning of the Wodehouse Karst Side Trail. Head east on the blue-blazed Wodehouse Karst Side Trail.
1.5	0.9	J1: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
2.0	1.2	J2: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Kimberley Forest Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
4.2	2.6	Heads-up: The next 0.8 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
4.4	2.8	J3: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Valley Crossover Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Valley Crossover Side Trail goes off on your right.)
5.3	3.3	Heads-up: The next 1.6 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
7.2	4.5	Heads-up: The next 0.8 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
7.8	4.8	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Kimberley Forest Side Trail, heading north-west. (the blue-blazed Valley Crossover Side Trail goes off on your left.)
10.2	6.3	J2: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
10.7	6.7	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Wodehouse Karst Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
12.2	7.6	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Visit Grey and a Geocaching.com site description; little was found on the Valley Crossover Side Trail.